The Hook Finder Playbook

How to find what your audience actually wants to hear, and turn it into 6 hooks you can post this week.

For solo women founders who are done guessing what to post.

By Cheyma Kahouach, Instagram strategist · @iamcheyma

THE *Own it* METHOD ®

Who I am and why you should listen

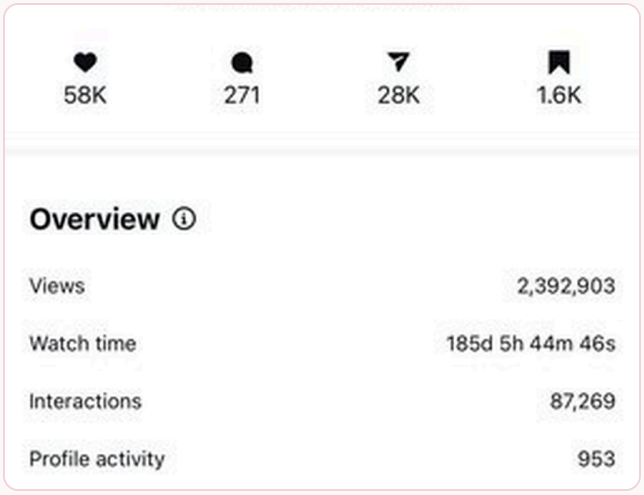
Let me be direct with you.

I'm not another Instagram coach teaching you to chase views that mean nothing. Views don't pay rent. Leads do. 🩷

I'm a social media strategist with 4 years of experience. My work has reached over 20 million people and helped clients bring in over $100K in revenue (appointments, bookings and product sales) in the last 6 months alone.

A few things that happened along the way

- One reel for an aesthetics doctor brought 2 new appointments overnight in October.
- A clinic went from 50 followers to a full waiting list in August.
- An educator's audience grew by 4,000 followers in 2 months, with over 400 product sales in September.



How I got here

I quit college to build this business. No degree, no daddy's money. My first big win was a local cafe. I reached out to the owner, and within a month their videos were getting 1M+ views each. That cafe became my portfolio and landed me my first international client.

But let me be honest. For a long time, my clients came from cold outreach and Upwork. When a project ended, I was back to zero. A dry pipeline is not fun, babe. So I'm building my own personal brand on Instagram. That's how I reached you. 🩷

The shift that changed everything

The turning point for my clients was never posting more. It was learning to say what their audience was already thinking. Secret is, if you describe their problem better than they can, they assume you have the solution.

The tool that makes it work? Hooks your audience would say themselves. 🌸

What you will get

This is not a "just post more and hope" guide. It's a simple way to turn your audience's own words into posts people stop for.

You'll do 3 things: say what you do in one clear sentence, find 5 things your audience already says online, and turn them into 6 hooks ready to post. No guessing. No copying what's trending.

One rule: do the exercises. Don't just read them. Writing it down is what works. 🎀

Part 1: Foundations

Chapter 1: Why your hooks fall flat

Your hooks are not failing because of the format. They fail for 3 reasons.

The 3 hook killers

1. You guess. You copy a viral hook, swap the topic and wonder why it didn't work. A hook only works when it says what your audience is already thinking.
2. You talk about you. Nobody stops for your morning routine unless it solves their problem.
3. Your message is fuzzy. If you can't say who you help and what for, your hook has nothing to stand on.

Viral is not the goal. In most cases, going viral is bad for business. It brings the wrong people 99% of the time. 5,000 right followers beat a million random ones.

Chapter 2: The Clarity Test

Before you write a hook, answer 3 questions:

1. Who is the ONE kind of person you help?
2. What ONE problem do you fix for her?
3. Can you say it in one sentence?

If it takes three sentences, make it shorter. If your friend can't say it back to you, it's too vague.

The formula

> "I help [who] turn [where she is now] into [what she wants] through [how you do it]."

Too vague: "I help women grow their business."

Clear: "I help solo wellness coaches turn a quiet Instagram into real client conversations through simple, honest posts."

Your turn. Say it out loud. If it sounds clunky, make it simpler.

> I help _____ (who?) turn _____ (where is she now?) into _____ (what does she want?) through _____ (how do you do it?)

Chapter 3: The shift

Old way: I post what I like and hope someone relates. New way: I post what my people already think, in the words they already use. That's the whole playbook in one line. It's why we start with research, not writing.

If your sentence is still fuzzy, fix it before you move on. Everything else builds on it.

Part 2: Your North Star

Step 1: Find the 5 things your audience already says

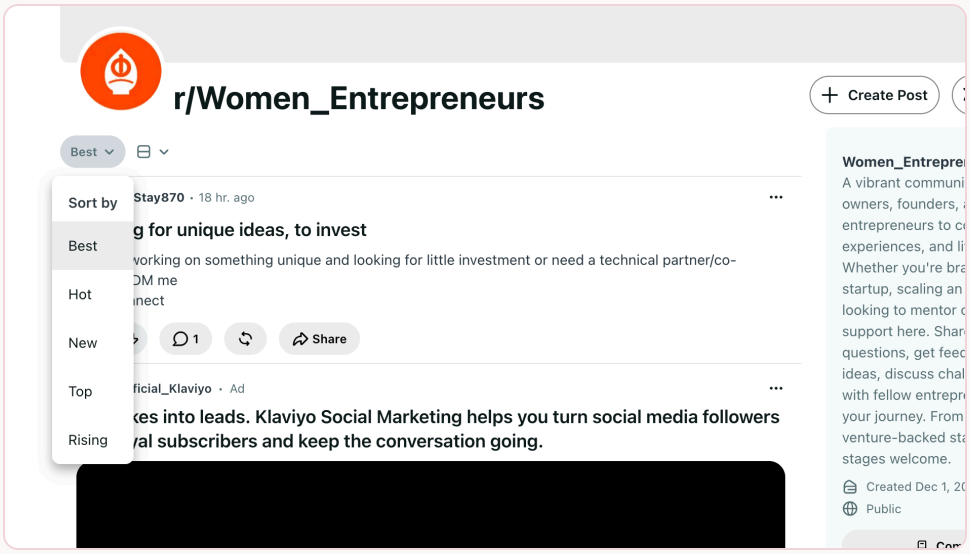
This is the step most people skip. It's the step that makes your hooks work. Your audience is already telling the internet what they want, what hurts and what they believe. You don't have to guess. You just have to read it.

Why I love Reddit

On Reddit, people are anonymous. Nobody is trying to look good for their followers. So they say the real thing. It's UNFILTERED. On Instagram, people clean up their words. On Reddit, they don't. That raw truth is gold for hooks. 🌸

How to search Reddit

1. Search your audience's problem plus words like "struggling", "tips" or "advice".
2. Find the subreddits for your niche and industry.
3. Sort the posts by Best, Hot, Top or Rising. Top shows what many people agree on. Hot shows what people are talking about right now. Both teach you something.

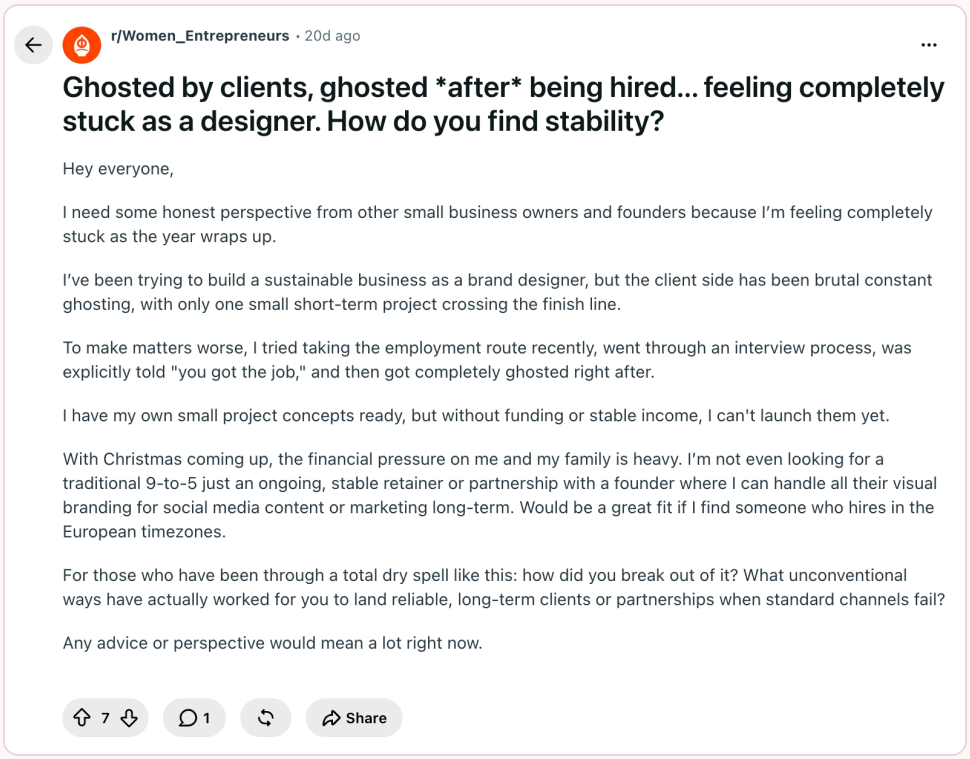


Also read: comments under bigger accounts in your niche, your own DMs and client calls, and questions people ask you in person.

The golden rule: use their exact words. Don't clean them up. Don't make them pretty. Their words are your hook words.

A quick note: the examples below are real posts from women on Reddit. They show you how to read a post. They are examples, not proof of what every woman thinks. Your own research is the

point.



Find 1: Dream outcomes

What do they want? Look for "I just want", "I wish", "my goal is".

Example, a woman designer writing about her own Instagram:

> "I just want to attract real people or small businesses who might need design work."

In plain words: real people who actually hire her.

Find 2: Pain points

What costs them time, money or energy? Look for "tired of", "struggling", "nothing works".

Example, a woman freelancer writing about herself:

> "a project ends, the pipeline is empty, and I start from zero. Every. Single. Time."

In plain words: an empty pipeline that keeps starting over.

Find 3: Myths

What do they believe that isn't true? People rarely say it out loud, so read between the lines. Look for "should I" and "is it better to".

Example, a woman designer writing about her own Instagram:

> “Any tips for converting followers into actual paying clients?”

The belief underneath: followers turn into clients. They don't. The right followers do. That's a myth you can bust in a hook.

Find 4: Their exact words

Which phrases keep showing up? These come from different women writing about their own work:

- “shouting into the void”
- “crickets”
- “feast-or-famine”
- “the pipeline is empty”
- “actual paying clients”

Save phrases like these. Use theirs, not yours.

Find 5: What they already tried

What failed before? This shows you the myths, the doubts and the pain all in one place.

Example, a woman freelancer writing about herself:

> “I've tried job boards (race to the bottom), cold DMs (mostly silence), and posting on social media (crickets). Then, when someone does reply, the conversation just… dies before it turns into a paid project.”

What it tells you: she tried 3 things, none worked, and the talk dies before it becomes a sale.

Your research sheet

Aim for at least 3 entries per row, from 3 different people.

The 5 finds	Their exact words	Where I found it
Dream outcomes		
Pain points		
Myths		
Exact words		
What they've tried		

Part 2, step 1 checkpoint

- [ ] I read posts from at least 2 places
- [ ] I wrote down their exact words, not my summary
- [ ] I filled all 5 rows
- [ ] I can finish this: "My audience wants ___, is stuck on ___, and believes ___."

Step 2: Your 6 hooks

Grab your research sheet. Fill the brackets with your audience's exact words from Step 1. The words you put in matter more than the format.

One honest rule: hooks 3, 4 and 6 need a true story. Use only real results. No big result yet? Use a smaller true one, or a client's result with their OK. Never make one up. Not sure where to start? Begin with hooks 1 and 5. They don't need a result.

Hook 1: The myth buster

[Common industry myth] is not [desired outcome]

Use: Find 3 and Find 1.

- Say the myth the way your audience says it.
- Kindly explain why people believe it.
- Share what really works, with one real example.
- End with a soft invite: reply with a keyword or DM you.

Example: "More followers is not more clients."

Hook 2: Your daily habits

[Number from 1 to 8] things I do every day to [major outcome] without [major industry myth]

Use: Find 1 and Find 3.

- One short line per habit, plus why it works.
- Only habits you really do. Best one last.

Example: "3 things I do every day to start real conversations without chasing followers."

Hook 3: The exact steps

These are the exact steps that [dream outcome] in under [time frame]

Use: Find 1 and Find 5.

- Give 3 to 5 steps in order, one line each.
- Say what you got and how long it really took.
- Point out the step most people skip.

No result yet? Make the time frame about how long the steps take, not what they'll earn.

Hook 4: The transformation

How I went from [struggling situation] to [dream outcome] in [time frame]

Use: Find 2 for the "from", Find 1 for the "to".

- Where you started, in words from Find 2.
- The moment it changed and the 3 things you did.
- Where you are now, with real numbers. Say what was hard.

Hook 5: Hills I'll die on

Hills I'll die on as a [relatable role] that has [dream outcome]

Use: Find 3 and Find 5.

- 3 to 5 strong opinions, one line each, plus a short "because".
- Start with your most unpopular one.
- Ask: "Which one did you disagree with?"

Example: "Hills I'll die on as a founder with a full DM inbox: followers don't equal clients."

Hook 6: The unhinged list

10/10 unhinged ways I [achieved dream outcome]

Use: Find 1 and Find 4.

- A funny, real list. Specific beats clever.
- Keep every item true. Best one last.

"Unhinged" means playful, not fake. Skip this one if it's not your tone.

Your hook worksheet

Hook	My filled in hook	Their words I used
1. Myth buster		
2. Daily habits		
3. Exact steps		
4. Transformation		
5. Hills I'll die on		
6. Unhinged list		

Part 3: Execution

Knowing is nice. Posting is what counts. Here's how to do it.

Your first 7 days

Day	What to do
1	Finish your Clarity sentence and start your research sheet
2	Finish your research sheet and fill in your hook worksheet
3	Post your first hook (start with hook 1 or 5)
4	Post your second hook. Reply to every comment and DM, and ask one real question back
5	Post your third hook
6	Post your fourth hook
7	Review: which hook got the most saves and real replies?

4 posts a week is my minimum. Please don't post for a week and then disappear for a month. It hurts you more than it helps. And don't judge a strategy after 3 days. Give it about 3 months of steady posting.

What to watch

Ignore likes, follower count and total views. Watch saves and shares, DMs and replies you start, and conversations with the right people. A qualified conversation is a real person who fits the woman you help, shows clear interest, and finds you through Instagram. Friends, other service providers and people with no budget don't count.

When a post flops

- Low reach? The hook isn't in their words. Use their exact phrases.
- Good reach but no DMs? Add one soft invite: reply with a keyword or send you a DM.
- The wrong people reply? Your message is too wide. Get more specific.

Don't blame the algorithm. Fix the hook first.

The 80/20 rule

Most results come from a few posts. After your first 4, look at the top 1 or 2: which hook, whose exact words, which myth or pain? Then make 3 new versions of the winner.

One more thing

You now have about 90% of what you need.

Do the work and your posts will start getting replies. 🩷

But here's what nobody tells you. Someone DMs you "tell me more." And then what do you say? Remember Find 5? The talk dies before it becomes a sale.

The next 3 messages decide if she books a call or goes quiet. I left that part out on purpose. It's the last 10%: the DM script.

I teach it inside Own It: 90 Days to Your First 10 Leads on Instagram, my 1:1 program for solo women founders. The promise: 10 qualified leads from Instagram in 90 days, or I keep working with you for free until you get them.

First cohort, Black Friday founding price, 10 spots. Enrollment closes November 27 at midnight New York time.

Apply for a spot 🩷

Pick a time and we talk. If Own It isn't a fit, I'll tell you. 🌸

THE *Own it* METHOD ®